health
Department:
Health
North West Provincial Government
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

WITRAND HOSPITAL
"Your satisfaction is our concern"

THE LINK

EXTERNAL NEWSLETTER
SPECIAL EDITION: 3RD QUARTER 2025/2026

Hospital Pharmacy Scoops Award For Medicine Availability

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Mental Health Awareness led by Ward 7

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EDITORIAL MESSAGE

Reflecting on our journey throughout 2025, Witrand Specialized Hospital has been on a steady march to polish its public image and sharpen its media relations. The effort has been methodical: we have refined messaging, cultivated relationships with journalists, and made a point of being transparent about our hospital activities including budget.

In the second quarter, however, we were thrust into the spotlight as a result of an unfortunate incident triggered a wave of media criticism that rippled through the institution, leaving many of our dedicated staff feeling demoralized.

The response was swift. MEC For Health Hon, Sello Lehari convened an independent investigative commission to get to the bottom of what happened. Surely, The findings will not only clear the air but also spark concrete actions to ensure such a situation never recurs.

One of the immediate hospital management interventions whilst awaiting the outcomes of the commission was a renewed focus on patient-safety-incident (PSI) training. Over the past years, PSI training has been a cornerstone of our safety culture, and this time we left no stone unturned: every employee, from front-line nurses to administrative assistants, completed a refreshed, scenario-based programme that emphasized early detection, reporting, and collaborative resolution.

Maintenance and facility safety remain top priorities, and a review of the human-resources structure is underway to align it with the specific needs of a specialist psychiatric hospital. Clinical interventions are being prioritized across all departments, and the province has been urged to accelerate infrastructure upgrades for Witrand.

Two-way communication is central to our strategy. We are using social media, radio interviews and open-day events to reach the community and showcase our services.

These efforts aim to rebuild our corporate identity as a reputable, reliable and people-centred institution.

As we look ahead, the progress we have made gives us confidence that we are on the right trajectory. The rapport we have nurtured with our patients, their families, and the broader community is a testament to the hard work of every employee.

We pledge to keep raising the bar, to listen attentively, and to act decisively, ensuring that Witrand Specialized Hospital remains a beacon of compassionate, high-quality care for years to come.

We welcome your comments, Inputs & suggestions for the improvement of this publication & the hospital in general. Do not hesitate to contact the Communications Unit or the CEO's Office. Enjoy the publication!

Mr. Nico Masiu
AD: Communications
Editor & Photography

Ms. Pako Lencwe
Marketing,
Communications &
Graphics

Message from the CEO

As the year draws to a close, I want to thank each of you for the hard work and dedication you bring to Witrand Specialised Hospital every day.

I am writing to let you know that I will retire from my role as Chief Executive Officer end of December 2025.

I leave knowing that we have built a talented, committed team, and I am confident that the hospital will continue to flourish under your leadership. Rest assured that I will do everything possible to make the hand-over as seamless as possible.

To our staff members, your compassion, expertise and teamwork truly make a difference in our patients' lives. To every unit, thank you for the care you provide and for embodying the hospital's mission. To our operational managers, your steady guidance and strong interpersonal skills have created a supportive environment for both patients and staff.

To nursing management, your leadership has cultivated a culture of excellence and high-quality care throughout the organisation. To the clinical team, your strategic approach, innovative practices and unwavering commitment have elevated patient safety and outcomes; your ability to balance work responsibilities with bedside realities has earned the respect of doctors, nurses and support staff alike.

To the Corporate Services Department admin, finance, human resources, Supply Chain and other Support service departments, you keep the hospital running smoothly.

Your proactive problem-solving, transparent communication and relentless efficiency provide the stable foundation that allows us to focus on patient care. I deeply appreciate your assertive support and the genuine engagement you bring to every activity.

Mrs M.E Mpolokeng
Chief Executive Officer

For the past 6 years that I have been working with you, I don't have any regrets. Instead, I grew to understand you more as reselient as you are which compliments my leadership as the CEO.

To anyone I may have unintentionally hurt while carrying out my responsibilities, I offer a sincere and heartfelt apology. At times we become so focused on the tasks at hand that we at some point step on other's toes.

As the festive season approaches, I wish you a joyous Christmas and a happy, prosperous New Year. Please take this time to rest, recharge and enjoy with your loved ones. Returning in 2026 refreshed and energised will be the greatest gift you can give our hospital.

Thank you for everything you do. Keep shining.

Witrand Specialized Hospital CEO; Mrs M.E Mpolokeng Retires.

Reflecting on The Journey We Travelled So Far.

Through her journey a the Acting CEO and subsequent CEO of Witrand Specialized Hospital, Mrs. Elizabeth Moipone Mpolokeng's foot steps as a proponent of exceptional quality and unwavering excellence, over the past 6 years are truly commendable.

Here are some of her notable accomplishments :

- **Hospital Rebranding and Renovation:** Successfully oversaw the rebranding and renovation of the hospital, including the installation of a ten-stiles gate, security boom gate, contravisions, and signage.
- **Infrastructure Improvement:** Refurbished the main kitchen, boiler, and wards with leaking roofs, ensuring a safe and comfortable environment for patients.
- **Medicine Availability:** Maintained an impressive medicine availability rate of 98%, including nutrition supplements, earning recognition from other hospitals.
- **Quality Service Improvement:** Improved quality service delivery by 80% compared to the previous 5-10 years, demonstrating her commitment to patient care.
- **Effective Administration:** Managed the hospital's administration efficiently, minimizing budget cuts and ensuring effective governance and oversight.
- **Talent Acquisition:** Successfully recruited key managers and program managers, filling strategic posts and strengthening the hospital's leadership.
- **New Services:** Established an outpatient forensic pathology service, expanding the hospital's offerings and improving healthcare access.
- **Employee Wellness:** Prioritized the health and wellness of employees, recognizing the importance of a supportive work environment.

Under her leadership, Witrand Specialized Hospital has become a benchmark for other hospitals, showcasing her exceptional management style and dedication to delivering high-quality healthcare services. Her retirement will undoubtedly be felt, but her legacy will continue to inspire and influence the healthcare sector. **End**

Outpatient Department Staff members bid farewell to Mrs M.E Mpolokeng

Ward 6 and Quality Assurance Staff members bid farewell to Mrs M.E Mpolokeng

Ward 7 Staff members bid farewell to Mrs M.E Mpolokeng

Laundry Staff members bid farewell to Mrs M.E Mpolokeng

Ward 9 Staff members bid farewell to Mrs M.E Mpolokeng

Tribute to CEO Mrs M.E Mpolokeng

Mrs. Elizabeth Mpolokeng , CEO of Witrand Specialized Hospital Retires.

It is with a deep sense of appreciation and respect that I announce the retirement of Ms Elizabeth Mpolokeng, CEO of Witrand Hospital, effective at the 31 December 2025.

Ms Mpolokeng retires after 42 years of dedicated, continuous, selfless and committed service to the Public Service in North West Department of Health. Her journey in health care has been long, impactful and inspiring. She has travelled the road from regional hospitals, with Potchefstroom Hospital being the institution where she spent more than 30 years of her professional career, serving with distinction.

She later moved to Ventersdorp District Hospital, now a CHC, where over a period of 6 years (2013–2019) she not only provided leadership, but also truly lived and experienced the concept of "UBUNTU" in service to the community.

In 2019, Ms Mpolokeng was promoted as the Nurse Manager for Specialty Services in Klerksdorp/Tshepong(KT) Hospital Complex. In November of the same year, she was seconded and subsequently lead as CEO of one of the most complex and challenging institutions in the province, Witrand Hospital. This facility soon became her home, and it was here that she fully explored, demonstrated and implemented her leadership competencies.

Her success involved high standard, ensuring ethical and dignified treatment with clinical intervention based on government policies and crucial clinical regulations.

Handover of gifts to the retiring CEO, Mrs M.E Mpolokeng.

There is no doubt that she has played a significant role in improving and changing the lives of vulnerable mental health care users through her dedication, efficiency and commitment to the effective running of Witrand Hospital. Her contribution to mental health services and to the broader health system has been exceptional.

On behalf of the Department, I extend our heartfelt gratitude to Mrs Mpolokeng for her outstanding service, exemplary leadership and unwavering commitment. We thank her for embracing the enormous responsibility of leading one of the largest psychiatric health establishments in the country, and for doing so with integrity, compassion and professionalism.

END

By Prof Binu Luke: Acting DDG HCSS

Some of the Clinical HODs together with the Infomation Management team during CEO's farewell

From left to right: **Ms P. Tlou** (Acting Chief Director; HCSS), **Mrs M.E Mpolokeng** (Retiring CEO), **Mr P Mokatsane** (DDG: HCSS) and **Mr D Mpolokeng** (Retiring OM: Ward 11) during CEO's farewell.

Witrand Specialized Hospital Pharmacy Awarded For Medicine Availability

Mrs M.E Mpoloken (CEO), Acompanied by Hospital Managemen and Dr Kenneth Kaunda District Pharmacy Management receiving a trophy and certificate under the category for Overall Medicine Availability in the North West Department of Health.

The Pharmacy Department at Witrand Specialized Hospital is known to be one of the best performing departments in the North West Department of Health. Their relentless drive for quality health services for all has set a benchmark for other facilities.

During Pharmacy Month celebration, solidifying its reputation for excellence, Witrand pharmacy was recently awarded a trophy and certificate under the category for Overall Medicine Availability in the North West Department of Health at the Branch Pharmacy Conference which was held at JB Marks Sub District.

Through their dedication and hard work, Witrand Specialised Hospital pharmacy team has long championed medicine availability across the province, ensuring that essential drugs are consistently in stock. This was made possible by teamwork, who work tirelessly to ensure that medicines are accessible to all patients, reinforcing the hospital's mission of equitable healthcare.

On behalf of Witrand Specialised hospital pharmacy personnel, CEO of Witrand Specialized Hospital, Mrs. M.E. Mpolokeng, received the trophy and certificate during the pharmacy branch conference. Expressing her pride, she said, "Receiving this award is a testament to the dedication and hard work of every pharmacist and support staff at Witrand'. 'It shows that when we unite for a common goal', 'which is reliable medicine for every patient', 'we achieve greatness".

"This recognition inspires us to keep pushing the boundaries of quality healthcare for the people we serve. "Added CEO

During hospital inspections, Witrand Pharmacy department consistently scores above 95% in the 2nd quarter 2025/2026, making it a standout performer in the hospital. The recognition comes after months of diligent stock management, staff training, and collaboration with regional health authorities. Witrand's pharmacy continues to set the standard for excellence in medicine supply and patient care.
Early this year, on the 14th February 2025, Minister of Health, Honourable Aron Motsoaledi announced the Six Month Multi-Month Dispensing (6MMD) programme. A game-changer for patients with chronic conditions! Instead of coming every month for medication.

The Six Month Multi-Month Dispensing programme forms part of the government's ongoing efforts to:

- Improve treatment access
- Enhance patient retention in care
- Reduce the burden on healthcare facilities caused by long queues
- Minimise the frequency of clinic visits

Just to share, this will drastically reduce congestion or influx at health service points. Let, alone relieve patients from long queues and long waiting times stresses at hospitals and clinics. Patients may consult in between only when they are sick instead of getting sick because of a facility influx.

Continues from pg 4

With the efficient management, distribution of medicine and a high % availability of medicine across the province. Based assessment, the North West Department is better positioned to provide adequate access to medication than the previous years.

Users can now receive a six-month supply of medication, reducing clinic visits to just two per year. This initiative aims to improve treatment access, enhance patient retention, and alleviate the burden on healthcare facilities.

The benefits are numerous - fewer clinic visits, less waiting time, and reduced stress. Patients can collect their medication and go about their daily lives without frequent hospital visits. Plus, with efficient medicine management and distribution, patients can trust that their medication will be available when they need it.

This is a testament to the department's commitment to quality health services for all. Some highlights from the North West Department of Health Pharmacy Month Recognition Awards include:

- Branch Pharmacy Overall Medicine Availability: JB Marks Sub District
- Special Award for Continuous Learning/Research Project: Dr Maryke Strydom
- Best Performing District - TB Medicine Availability: Dr Kenneth Kaunda District
- Best Performance Overall Medicine Availability: Dr Kenneth Kaunda District

The 6MMD programme is available at select facilities as of August 1, 2025, and will roll out to all facilities by April 1, 2026. Ask your healthcare provider if you're eligible!. **End**

Witrand Pharmacy Staff and hospital management bid a warm farewell to outgoing Witrand Hospital CEO, Mrs. Moipone Mpolokeng

Witrand Specialized Hospital Mental Health Month Awareness Spearheaded by NWU students in collaboration with Ward 7.

From left to right: Prof E Du Plessis with colleagues and volunteer students from NWU Nursing Faculty facilitating Mental Health Awareness.

Witrand Specialised Hospital inaugurated its Mental Health Month observance on 16–17 May 2025, a programme spearheaded by North-West University (NWU) students in collaboration with staff from Ward 7. The initiative unfolded sequentially in Ward 7, then extended to Wards 8 and 2, with the occupational-therapy department playing a central role.

Participants were invited to submit their personal mental-health coping strategies anonymously through an online platform; the collected responses will be presented as a word-cloud later in the month. Complementary activities included a guided fun-walk with patients led by NWU volunteers, distribution of stress-relief balls, health-screening for chronic conditions among mental-health service users, and a series of indoor recreational games.**End**

NWU Nursing Students screening Mental Health patients

Mental Health Patients participating during funwalk for Mental Health Day.

MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS

"Access to Services – Mental Health in Catastrophes and Emergencies"

Why Mental Health Must Be a Priority

- Crises amplify existing mental health needs.
- Globally, 1 in 8 people live with a mental health condition.
- Many affected by trauma, displacement, or natural disasters face no access to care.
- Investing in mental health services improves individual, community, and global resilience.

What Can You Do?

✅ Raise Awareness

- Share facts about mental health in emergencies.
- Acknowledge the trauma and stress people face during catastrophes.

✅ Support Access

- Advocate for trauma-informed mental health services in your community.
- Donate to or volunteer with organisations serving vulnerable populations.

✅ Take Care of Your Mental Health

- Check in with yourself and others—especially during or after crises.
- Know the signs of distress and seek support early.

Tools for Mental Well-being (Even in Crisis)

- Ground yourself with slow breathing
- Limit news exposure during emergencies
- Connect with safe people
- Express yourself through art, journaling, or movement
- Seek professional help Early support can be life-saving

WITRAND SPECIALIZED HOSPTAL SOCIAL WORK DEPARTMENT

Witrand Specialized Hospital

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health Department: Health North West Provincial Government REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

24-hour toll-free emergency helplines:

- Mental Health Helpline: 080 045 6789
- Suicide Crisis Helpline: 080 056 0567
- Cipla Mental Health Helpline: 080 045 6789
- NPOwer SA Helpline: 080 051 5515
- Healthcare Workes Care Network Helpline: 080 021 2121

WITRAND HOSPITAL "Your satisfaction is our concern"

Witrand Hospital & JB Marks Local Schools Join Forces To Fight Stroke

Ms Kutlwano Mtimkulu: Witrand Specialized Hospital HOD: Speech and Audiologist together with **Mrs Renathe van der Merwe:** National Coordinator for the FAST Heroes Stroke awareness program in South Africa during stroke awareness campaign in Mohadin Primary School.

Witrand Specialized Hospital's multi-disciplinary team consisting of Physiotherapy, Speech Therapy and Audiology Department has recently partnered with FAST Heroes Southern Africa to educate children about the signs of stroke and the importance of swift action. This outreach program was rolled out over a period of 3 weeks from the 10th November to 22nd November 2025 with 5 lessons given to the learners.

The campaign targets children aged 5-9 years, aiming to empower them with life-saving knowledge about stroke risks to share with their families, particularly grandparents.

Over 140 Grade 1 and 2 learners from Mohadin and Promosa Primary Schools participated in the program, which was rolled out over three weeks. The children received educational books, pencils, and activities to make learning fun and engaging. They were introduced to the grand heroes: Frank, Armando, Sophia, and Timmy, who help remember the FAST acronym.

Witrand Hospital serves patients with rehabilitation needs such as Cerebral Visual Impairment, Spinal Cord Injury and Traumatic Brain Injury.

As clinicians working in the rehabilitation unit, it has been observed that patients delay to present to their nearest health facility upon having a stroke as result of a lack of knowledge about identifying the signs and symptoms.

As a hospital, we are the first health facility to champion this campaign as its aim is primarily for teachers to implement in the classroom.

The initiative is crucial, as many stroke patients delay seeking medical attention due to lack of awareness about symptoms. By teaching children to recognize Face drooping, Arm weakness, Speech difficulties, and the importance of time to call emergency services.

"We're thrilled to be part of this life-changing campaign," said Mrs. Ina Motaung, Head of Physiotherapy department at Witrand Specialized Hospital. "By educating children, we're not only saving lives but also empowering communities. Involving children is genius - it embeds essential knowledge early and can help with wider community awareness by sparking interest amongst their wider family. The overarching aim is to help ensure that our Heroes have a better chance to survive with their lives intact thanks to effective and fast treatment," emphasized Mrs Motaung.

The campaign leverages children's enthusiasm for learning and sharing, encouraging them to spread knowledge to their families and communities, promoting incidental learning and awareness.

Grade 1 and 2 learners from Mohadin Primary Schools participating during the FAST Heroes Stroke awareness program

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Emphasising the outcomes Ms. Kutlwano Mtimkulu said "We know that outcomes for stroke are improved if stroke signs are spotted and people get access to high quality acute care as quickly as possible". A key pillar of the World Stroke Campaign.

Jan Van Der Merwe from the Boehringer Ingelheim Angels Initiative, who leads the FAST Heroes campaign, said: "We're delighted that over 150,000 children have taken part via their school so far and helped pass potentially life-saving knowledge onto their families and look forward to continuing to work with WSO members to expand the program in future."

Come next year, FAST Heroes campaign will continue recruiting new teachers and schools as it works towards its mission of educating a million children from across our communities about stroke. **End**

Mrs Mamello Kobeqo: Speech and Audiologist together with **Mrs Inaeng Motaung: Physiotherapy HOD** hand over certificate and present to learners during stroke awareness campaign: FAST HEROES

Witrand Specialised Hospital Appreciate the touch of life brought by NWU Students for Creative Therapy Project in Ward 8.

NWU Volunteer students painting the walls with cheerful characters, transforming Ward 8 into a vibrant therapeutic space.

The management of Witrand Specialised Hospital recently approved a community-engagement initiative that saw students from the North-West University (NWU) transform the television room in Ward 8 into a vibrant therapeutic space including gardening.

Permission was granted to the NWU team to paint the walls with cheerful characters, install soft knitted mats and create tyre swings for the patients. According to the hospital's Nursing Manager, Matron Evelyn Gorekwang, the project aligns with the facility's commitment to enhancing the mental-well-being of its long-term care users.

"We are grateful for this partnership, which not only brightens the environment but also provides meaningful stimulation for our patients." said Mrs Gorekwang.

This initiative infused Ward 8 with colour and playfulness, offering patients a welcoming area for recreation and relaxation.

These collaborative efforts foster a sense of community and contribute positively to the recovery journey of those receiving care.

Witrand Specialised Hospital continues to welcome partnerships that enrich the lives of its patients and support its mission of holistic, patient-centred care. **End**

Student volunteers tilting and planting follower seeds in Ward 8.

Patients participated in some organised games

Spreading Joy and Warmth

Witrand Specialized Hospital's Carols by Candle Lighting

From Left to Right: Mrs S Legoale, Ms M Serobatse, Mrs M.E Mpolokeng (CEO) and Mr D Mpolokeng during Patients' Carol by Candle Lighting

Witrand Specialized Hospital hosted a heartwarming Carols by Candle Lighting event for patients on December 4, 2025. The event aimed to bring joy, comfort, and festive cheer to those spending the holiday season in the hospital.

The program led by Sr. Fourie, featured a range of traditional Christmas carols performed by talented individuals and groups, including Op die stoep Orkes band. Patients and staff alike sang along to familiar favorites like "Silent Night," "Joy to the World," and "Jingle Bells."

The event was made possible by the dedication and hard work of the hospital's management and activity staff, as well as support from sponsors like Talking Hands, Second Life, Buco, Josh Levy, Op die Stoep Orkes, Morne Grobler, Jacques Viljoen, Go Wear Promo and Gifts, and Old Mutual.

The Hospital CEO, Mrs. ME Mpolokeng expressed her gratitude to the patients for allowing the hospital to care for them. "It is a privilege to serve you, and we are honored to be a part of your journey towards wellness," she said.

The event was a resounding success, with patients and staff alike visibly moved by the beautiful music and warm atmosphere. "Seeing our patients smile and sing along to their favorite carols was truly priceless. It's moments like these that remind us of the true meaning of Christmas which is love, kindness, and compassion." said Mrs M.E Mpolokeng.

The Carols by Candle Lighting event was a poignant reminder of the hospital's commitment to providing holistic care to its patients, addressing not just their physical needs but also their emotional and spiritual well-being.

The hospital would like to extend its gratitude to all involved in making this event a success and wishes all a joyous and peaceful holiday season and challenges as well as the staff outstanding. **End**

Op die stoep Orkes band: Mr Morne Grobler and Mr Jacques Viljoen together with Ms Carol Eleveld (Activity Center Therapist)

Patients jamming to the music and singing along to Jingle bells, joy to the world, we wish you a marry christmas,etc during Carols by Candle Lighting.

Festive Season brought smiles & Gifts for patients

Heartfelt thank you to To PGB Toy Project Volunteers.

heartfelt gratitude goes to Lerato Metsing, Ms. Mokgethoa Senyatsi of the PGB Toy Project – "Phisego Go Bana" (Passion for Kids), who brought toys for ward 6 patients to enjoy the festive season.

Witrand Specialized Hospital's management extends its heartfelt gratitude to Ms. Mokgethoa Senyatsi of the PGB Toy Project – "Phisego Go Bana" (Passion for Kids) – and her colleague Lerato Metsing, who visited the hospital during the Christmas season.

The pair delivered a collection of toys to patients in Ward 6, aiming to share God's love and bring smiles to the children.

Hospital officials say the gesture created a memorable day for the patients, who received the gifts with great joy and have already become inseparable from their new toys. The donation has brightened the ward and will be remembered by staff and patients alike.

Some of Gifts from PGB Toy Project – "Phisego Go Bana" (Passion for Kids)

Witrand Specialised Hospital Thanks Ubuntu Church For Toy-Project Volunteers.

Ubuntu Family Centre Church delivered toys to children in the children's ward as part of the church's ongoing community outreach.

The gifts were collected and donated by church members. Children at Witrand Hospital received an early Christmas surprise when volunteers from the Ubuntu Family Centre delivered toys to children in the children's ward as part of the church's ongoing community outreach.

Hospital Management Thank Ubuntu Church for Reaching out our patients.

Ward 8 staff who spoiled their patients with early Christmas gift & food

Witrand Specialized Hospital shows gratitude to the Van Der Walt family

Van Der Walt family Me Carel & Johan (standing from far Right) with Ward4 staff memebers handed over generous Christmas gifts to Ward 4 patients on 23 December 2025. the patients enjoyed the goodies.

Witrand Specialised Hospital wishes to thank the Van Der Walt family for the generous Christmas gifts handed over to Ward 4 patients on 23 December 2025. The thoughtful goodies brought smiles to patients and staff alike, creating a cherished moment that will be remembered long after the festive season.

During the handover, Mrs Carel Van Der Walt explained that the donation of snacks was made in gratitude to the hospital team for the care they provided to her brother, Johan Van Der Walt, from 1991 until his passing in 2014. "We saw the joy on the patients' faces and the staff when they enjoyed the cake, chips and cool drinks," she said. "Although modest, the gesture was a small way to give back and we are delighted to have made a difference."

The hospital extends its heartfelt appreciation to the Van Der Walt family and wishes everyone a joyous Christmas and a prosperous New Year in 2026. **End**

Mrs Inge Jones inspires Mental Health patients in Ward 2

Mrs. Inge Jones in her personal capacity (Non-Political), came to say thank you to staff of Witrand for sterling work and evident commitment to provide compassionate yet professional service to mental health patients in Ward 2.

Patient of Ward2 enjoyed themselve with cake and juice gifted by Mr Enge Jones. This was indeed a moment of joy and happiness.

Mrs Inge Jones visited the male psychiatric ward at Witrand Specialized Hospital on the 25 December 2025 . She came to convey her heartfelt thanks to the hospital and the ward's staff for the role they played in her brother's recovery from addiction which is a journey that has now led him to a successful teaching career in China. "Seeking help brings hope, and there are opportunities for anyone to turn their life around," she said to the patients.

Mrs. Jones also donated a Christmas cake for the ward's patients. Responding to the gesture, Sr Shelly Daniel, **(Operational Manager for Ward6)**, commended her as a true Samaritan, saying the gratitude she showed would inspire patients to pursue recovery and take charge of their lives after discharge. She added that the cake and juice were already bringing joy to the patients.

Mr. Machobane, the ward's Nurse in-charge, thanked Mrs. Jones for making time in her busy schedule to remember Witrand, noting that the treats were already being enjoyed by those on the ward. **End**

Official Witrand Hospital Radio Slots: Empowering Communities through Health Awareness

Ms Kgaugelo Manthata (Speech and Audiologist) together with Ms Kiston Verschwren (Occupational Therapist) and Mr Ramario Kalie (Physiotherapist)

As part of Witrand Specialized Hospital's commitment to promoting health and mental wellness, Aganang FM has been hosting radio slots to raise awareness on various health issues. These slots are crucial in bridging the gap between healthcare providers and the community, providing accurate and reliable information on critical health topics.

The radio slots are scheduled in line with the Health Calendar, covering awareness campaigns such as Epilepsy , Mental Health, Obesity, Down Syndrome, Head & Spine Injury, Autism, Hand Hygiene, Substance Abuse, Food Safety, etc.

These radio slots are important because they:

- Empower communities with knowledge to make informed health decisions
- Reduce stigma around sensitive health topics
- Promote healthy lifestyles and disease prevention
- Support those affected by various health conditions

Caroline Mathule together Goitumetswe Lephoi-Jonson; Admissions Staff officers gave a ttalk on admission requirements Uniform Patient Fees Structure, and revenue collections etc etc.

"We commend the efforts of Aganang FM and the presenters who have taken part in these radio slots." said Mrs. ME Mpolokeng, Hospital CEO.

"The impact of these radio slots is evident in the community's growing awareness and understanding of various health issues. We encourage everyone to continue listening and participating." emphasized Mr. Nico Masiu: Assistant Director for Communications.

The Communication Department extends its gratitude to the presenters for sharing their expertise and to our listeners for engaging with these important topics. Together, we can work towards a healthier community.

Let's continue to support these initiatives and work towards a healthier community. **End**

Mr Jomo Mailula : Dietician who presented on “Food for all, health for All: National Nutrition Week (NNW) is observed annually in October to raise awareness about the importance of healthy eating.
SA govt, together with a wide range of stakeholders, recognizes that proper nutrition and a balanced diet particularly for children are essential for optimal physical and mental health, as well as overall development. Good nutrition in adulthood is equally important for preventing disease, sustaining productivity, and promoting overall well-being.

Psychologist Antletse Phiriepa and Symphathy Molaudzi Presented on Mental Health challenges and consequence of Untreated mental health.

Sr. O Sekete talked about Cerebral Palsy & Epilepsy, Sr S. Bole presented on referral to specialized services, importance of honoring apointments, bookings and referral procedure, and Mr Sekoele spoke on intelectual disabilities, etc.

Sizzling Fun at Witrand Hospital's Braai Day

Witrand Hospital Staff members participating during funwalk kickstarting Braai Day

Witrand Specialized Hospital convened a highly successful Braai Day on 5 December 2025, an event orchestrated by the hospital's Physiotherapy unit with the aim of uniting staff in a relaxed, enjoyable setting that encouraged fellowship and rejuvenation.

The day kicked off with a fun walk, getting everyone energized and ready for the exciting activities that followed, such as Indoor games (pool and table tennis).

The real excitement was outdoors, where a slip 'n slide and jumping castle provided endless laughter and entertainment.

Mr Ben Mothokgo together with Dr Isaac Wana playing table tennis.

Staff members having fun on slip 'n slide and jumping castle

"Just relax and Braai" was the theme of the day.

The braai was a true potluck affair, with staff members bringing their favorite meats, sides, and snacks to share with colleagues.

"It was an amazing day, and exactly what we needed to unwind and connect with our colleagues," said Mr Onkabetse Ntasi.

The event was a testament to the hospital's commitment to staff well-being and team building. "We wanted to create a space where staff could let their hair down and have some fun, It was incredible to see everyone laughing, playing, and enjoying each other's company." said the Physiotherapy HOD: Mrs Inaeng Motaung.

The Braai Day was a wonderful opportunity for staff to recharge and refocus, ready to take on the challenges of the festive season.

We wish that this could happen at least twice a year. Just like Braai Day, we encourage staff members to actively participate during the Health and Wellness activities. Management is always ready to release the staff members for Wellness Programmes. **End**

HR Department staff together with Housekeeping and Pharmacy colleagues ***"Just relax and Braai"***

Witrand chillers, ***"Just relax and Braai"***

THROUGH THE LENS

Farewell to Witrand Specialized Hospital CEO, Mrs Moipone Elizabeth Mpolokeng – A visionary leader whose dedication has transformed our attitude towards users and set a standard of professionalism to us all.

Mrs M.E Mpolokeng Handing out thank you cards in appreciation to HOD'S during her last review meeting

KT Hospital Complex recently came for inspection as part of per review at Witrand Hospital, this also pave way for benchmark on best practices.

Witrand hospital employees unwind after a breath talking fun-work and enjoyed the Bring & Braai Day as part of Health and Wellness programme

THROUGH THE LENS

NWU volunteer students from the NWU Nursing School joined Witrand Hospital during Mental Health Month for a celebration filled with activities focused on psychiatric patients and staff.

Witrand Hospital recently hosted its end-of-2025 Sports Tournament, a highlight of the Transformation Games where three institutions competed across various sporting codes. Employees enjoyed the lively event, which is part of our Health and Wellness Programme. A heartfelt thank you to our sponsors—Sanlam, Old Mutual, Liberty and Mediware—for standing by us and helping make the tournament a memorable success.

Hospital Management welcomes Occupational Hygienist student Hospital Management together with the OHS and

A massive turnout of staff, families and friends of our patients at the successful "Patients' Carols by Candlelight" hosted by the Activity Centre. The highlight was the invitation of the live band "Op die Stoep Orkes," whose wonderful performance was received with joy. patients were given the chance to sing along to Christmas and joyous songs. Our patients were thrilled, and the evening became a memorable celebration of joy.

Witrand staff gathered for a Patient Safety Incident presentation by Dr. Isaac Wana (Far right), who has championed PSI for the past three years. All employees have now been trained on PSI.

Outgoing CEO, Mrs Moipone Mpolokeng, bids farewell all staff members during her visits to their workspaces. She Thanked all staff members who play a significant role during her turner, and being resilience. "i am grateful for your compassion and expertise. thank you for making a difference in our patients; lives" said Mrs. Mpolokeng.

WITRAND HOSPITAL

"Your satisfaction is our concern"

HOSPITAL OPEATING HOURS

Clinical	Nursing	Clinical & Nursing
Services rendered Mondays – Fridays: 07:30 – 16:00 Medical officer on call after hours	24 Hours services rendered Mondays- Sundays Including Public Holidays	Outpatient Department: Psychiatry: Wednesday's & Thursday's: 07:00 – 16:00 Physical Medicine & Rehab: Tuesdays 07:00 – 16:00

HOSPITAL VISITING HOURS

Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation Unit	Psychiatric Unit	Intellectual Disabled Units
Mondays – Fridays: 15:30 – 16:30 19:00 – 20:00 **Weekends:** 15:30 – 16:30 19:00 – 20:00	**Monday – Fridays:** 15:30 – 16:30 18:00 – 18:45 **Weekends:** 15:30 – 16:30 18:00 – 18:45	Monday – Fridays: 10:00 – 16:00 **Weekends:** 10:00 –16:00 19:00 – 20:00

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We welcome your comments, Inputs & suggestions for the improvement of this publication & the hospital in general. Do not hesitate to contact the Communications Unit or the CEO's Office.

Witrand Specialized Hospital
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